

Question:

A 52-year-old woman complains of intermittent diffuse abdominal pain that becomes worse after eating meals and several episodes of diarrhea, the last of which was bloody. These symptoms have been present for the previous 6 months but have worsened recently. She has had significant weight loss since the onset of symptoms. Her past medical history includes systemic lupus erythematosus (SLE), which has been difficult to manage medically. Vital signs include a blood pressure of 100/70 mm Hg, temperature of 37.1°C (98.8 °F), and pulse of 95/min. On physical examination, the patient appears to be in severe pain, and there is mild diffuse abdominal tenderness. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Ischemic bowel disease
- B. Ulcerative colitis
- C. Small bowel obstruction
- D. Acute pancreatitis

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> reasoning process : Identifying the reasoning involves breaking down the process : Breaking down the process involves decomposing the problem into smaller parts and evaluating them one by one </think><answer> A. Ischemic bowel disease </answer>

